

# SOF IEO — Topic Deep-Dive: Vocabulary

For Ambar, Class III CBSE

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## 1. What IEO tests under “Vocabulary”

Five question families appear again and again: 1. **Synonyms** — words with the SAME meaning (happy = glad). 2. **Antonyms** — words with the OPPOSITE meaning (open vs shut). 3. **Odd word out** — three words belong to a group, one does not. 4. **Collocations** — words that go together (a *bunch* of grapes, a *clap* of thunder). 5. **Spelling** — pick the correctly spelled word from four look-alikes.

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## 2. Synonyms — must-know pairs

| Word  | Same as      | Word  | Same as |
|-------|--------------|-------|---------|
| happy | glad, joyful | begin | start   |
| small | tiny, little | end   | finish  |
| quick | fast         | shout | yell    |
| angry | cross        | gift  | present |
| neat  | tidy         | weep  | cry     |
| big   | large, huge  | brave | bold    |

**Trap:** in synonym questions one option is always the OPPOSITE. Read the question twice — “means the same” or “means the opposite”?

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## 3. Antonyms — must-know pairs

| Word  | Opposite | Word     | Opposite |
|-------|----------|----------|----------|
| big   | small    | hot      | cold     |
| day   | night    | open     | shut     |
| empty | full     | always   | never    |
| buy   | sell     | remember | forget   |
| heavy | light    | noisy    | quiet    |
| first | last     | victory  | defeat   |
| brave | cowardly | ancient  | modern   |

**Trap:** the “almost opposite” distractor — for *hot*, the answer is **cold**, not *cool* or *warm*.

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## 4. Odd word out — think “what group is this?”

Name the group first, then find the outsider. - apple, mango, banana, **potato** → fruits vs a vegetable - rose, lotus, marigold, **mango** → flowers vs a fruit - doctor, teacher, farmer, **hospital** → people vs a place - January, **Monday**, March, July → months vs a day - whisper, murmur, mutter, **shout** → quiet sounds vs a loud one

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## 5. Collocations (words that go together)

| Phrase                   | Phrase            |
|--------------------------|-------------------|
| a bunch of grapes / keys | a clap of thunder |

a flock of sheep / birds  
a swarm of bees  
a loaf of bread  
a bar of soap / chocolate  
a glass of milk

a herd of cattle / elephants  
a litter of puppies  
a slice of bread / cake  
a sheet of paper  
a dozen bananas

**Trap pairs:** flock (sheep, birds) vs herd (cattle, elephants); sheet of paper vs slice of bread.

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## 6. Spelling — the words children misspell most

because, friend, school, beautiful, Wednesday, February, tomorrow, different, vegetable, colour, hungry, umbrella, birthday, holiday, library.

**How IEO asks it:** four spellings, one correct. Read letter by letter; the traps double a letter (tomorrow), drop a letter (Wednesday) or swap two letters (friend).

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## 7. Common traps

| Trap                                                | How to beat it                                                    |
|-----------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Same vs opposite confusion                          | Underline the word SAME or OPPOSITE in the question.              |
| Near-opposite distractor (cool for hot)             | Pick the fullest opposite, not the mild one.                      |
| Synonym pair inside an antonym question (big-large) | Opposites must clash; big-large agree, so they are NOT opposites. |
| Wrong collective (herd of sheep)                    | Sheep and birds flock; cattle and elephants herd.                 |
| Look-alike spellings                                | Check the middle letters — that is where traps hide.              |

## 8. High-frequency IEO question types

1. "Which word means the same as \_\_\_?"
  2. "The opposite of \_\_\_ is \_\_\_."
  3. "Which word is spelled correctly?"
  4. "Odd word out."
  5. "A \_\_\_ of bees flew out." (collocation blank)
  6. **Achiever's:** meaning from context — "Raju was so *exhausted* that he fell asleep." (exhausted = very tired), and "Which pair are opposites?"
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## 9. Key facts checklist

- Synonym = same meaning; antonym = opposite meaning.
  - Read whether the question wants SAME or OPPOSITE.
  - Odd one out: name the group first.
  - flock-sheep, herd-cattle, swarm-bees, litter-puppies, bunch-grapes.
  - Master the 15 spelling words above.
  - In context questions, the sentence itself hints at the meaning (fell asleep → very tired).
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## 10. Quick drill (10 questions)

1. Which word means the same as 'glad'? (sad / happy / angry / slow)
2. The opposite of 'full' is \_\_\_\_\_. (heavy / empty / open / round)

3. Which is spelled correctly? (Febuary / February / Februray / Febrary)
4. Odd one out: (cat / dog / cow / crow)
5. A \_\_\_ of elephants crossed the river. (flock / swarm / herd / bunch)
6. Which word means the same as 'shut'? (open / close / push / lock)
7. The opposite of 'ancient' is \_\_\_. (old / modern / broken / tall)
8. Odd one out: (pencil / eraser / sharpener / kitchen)
9. Which is spelled correctly? (umberella / umbrella / umbrela / umbrellla)
10. "The room was in a *mess* after the party." 'Mess' means the room was \_\_\_. (clean / untidy / empty / dark)

**Answers:** 1. happy 2. empty 3. February 4. crow (the rest are four-legged animals) 5. herd 6. close 7. modern 8. kitchen (the rest are stationery) 9. umbrella 10. untidy